

MICHAELA MCROWDIE

Full Stack Developer

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PROFILE

Full Stack Developer with 2+ years' experience delivering production SaaS platforms, internal systems and APIs. Backend depth in PHP (Laravel) and Python (Django), with frontend experience in Vue.js, React and modern JavaScript (ES6+). Currently building out backend services at Dev Science, following production experience across CRM, HR-tech and youth-development platforms. Comfortable across the full lifecycle — architecture, development, testing, deployment and performance optimisation.

CORE TECHNICAL SKILLS

Backend: PHP (Laravel), Python (Django, DRF), Node.js, Java

Frontend: JavaScript (ES6+), TypeScript, Vue.js, React, HTML5, CSS3, Bootstrap

Databases: MySQL (performance tuning, complex queries), PostgreSQL, MongoDB, SQLite

DevOps & Tools: AWS (S3), Docker, Git, GitHub, Heroku, DigitalOcean

Web Servers: Apache, Nginx

Testing & APIs: PHPUnit, Jasmine, RESTful APIs, JSON, Selenium, UAT

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Full Stack Developer — Dev Science (Pty) Ltd

Aug 2026 – Present

- Joined as Full Stack Developer, reporting to the Managing Director, building and maintaining production backend services in a hybrid working environment
- Onboarding onto the company's codebase and delivery workflow during initial probation period, with early focus on backend feature development and API work

FullStack Software Developer — SkillsPanda

Jul 2025 – Jul 2026

- Developed and maintained scalable backend systems using Laravel, MySQL and Django
- Designed and integrated RESTful APIs for internal and external services
- Optimised database performance and improved system reliability
- Collaborated with frontend teams working in Vue.js and React

Key Projects

- Internal Operations CRM (SaaS Platform): built and enhanced a CRM for managing intern and student operations, implementing backend logic, reporting systems, API integrations and workflow automation
- Kind Regards Platform (kindregards.careers): backend developer on a live platform — built and maintained backend services using Laravel and MySQL, developed APIs and business logic, and contributed to performance and scalability improvements

Junior Software Developer — Connect HR

Oct 2024 – Jul 2025

- Built and maintained web applications using Django, Laravel, React, Bootstrap and JavaScript
- Implemented new features, optimised databases and improved system performance

Key Projects

- Student Profile System: designed and implemented a student management system using Django/FastAPI and Vue.js
- Booking System: developed a scheduling platform with an intuitive user interface
- Website Development: built and deployed multiple responsive websites

Tech Administrator — YES Programme

Feb 2024 – Dec 2024

- Provided technical and QA support for web applications
- Verified system functionality across browsers and devices
- Supported testing processes and release readiness

FEATURED PROJECTS

CRM System (Laravel SaaS Platform)

- Built a scalable CRM using Laravel, MySQL and modern JS frameworks (Vue/React)
- Features: dashboards, analytics, lead tracking, automated notifications

PandaBot Platform (Production Application)

- Backend developer on a live system used for youth development
- Built using Laravel, MySQL and modern frontend frameworks
- Developed APIs, handled business logic and improved performance

Learning Management System

- Built with Django/FastAPI, PostgreSQL, Vue.js
- Features: authentication, role-based access, progress tracking

LEADERSHIP & COMMUNITY

Google Developer Groups Soweto

- Lead Editor (March 2023 – Present)
- Diversity & Inclusion Ambassador (October 2023 – Present)
- Organised developer events, supported community growth and promoted inclusive participation

EDUCATION

- WeThinkCode — Information Systems: Software Engineering, NQF 5
- Umuzi — Business Analysis, NQF 5

Certifications

- IBM Applied DevOps Engineering Professional Certificate — in progress
- Coursera Professional Certificate — Meta Full Stack Developer: Front-End & Back-End Specialization
- WeThinkCode — GenAI Course for Software Engineers
- FNB App Academy — FullStack Development
- GirlCode — Python Bootcamp
- Tech4Dev — Web Development

VOLUNTEER EXPERIENCE

Technical Events Volunteer, Mentor & Designer *(June 2023 – December 2024)*

GirlCode ZA, FIRST Lego League, WeThinkCode, DigiMarCon

- Supported tech events and hackathons, mentored participants on projects, assisted with interviews and registrations, contributed to graphic design deliverables, and served as a referee at national competitions

References available on request